

10 most Powerful Ideas in Software Engineering

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Abstract

At software engineering's 40th birthday, do we know which software engineering ideas matter most? In this talk, award-winning author Steve McConnell identifies 10 of the most powerful ideas in software engineering. McConnell explains how the 10 ideas form the foundation for effective software development, and he shows how practices ranging from the waterfall model to extreme programming measure up. He uses these key ideas to explain which currently popular software engineering practices will withstand the test of time, and which are fleeting fads.

Biography

Steve McConnell is best known as author of *Software Estimation: Demystifying the Black Art*, *Code Complete 2nd Edition*, *Rapid Development*, and other software industry classics. His first two books won Software Development magazine's Jolt Excellence award for best programming books of their years.

In 1998, readers of Software Development magazine named Steve one of the three most influential people in the software industry along with Bill Gates and Linus Torvalds. He is past Editor in Chief of IEEE Software magazine and past Chair of the IEEE Professional Practices Committee.

Steve currently works as CEO and Chief Software Engineer at Construx Software (www.construx.com), where he personally works with a few select clients to improve their software development practices, and also oversees the rest of Construx's work with many other companies. Steve can be reached at stevemcc@construx.com.